measured in kilograms or pounds using adult or infant weighing scale.

Nursing Alert

Children less than 2 years of age – Weigh the child without clothes or a diaper using a digital infant scale. Position child in the center of the scale tray and read the measurement to the nearest 0.1 kg.

Children more than 2 years of age – Weigh the child on an electronic floor scale with increments less than or equal to 0.1 kg. Weigh young children without shoes and wearing underclothes only, unless privacy cannot be assured. For older children and young children when privacy is a concern, weigh the child wearing minimal inner clothing and without shoes. Request child or adolescent stand in the center platform of the scale and remain motionless until the measurement can be obtained. Measure the weight to the nearest 0.1 kg.

Purposes

- To check whether an infant/child has adequate weight for age
- To calculate nutritional requirements
- To calculate the quantity of intravenous fluids and medications
- To monitor the progress of weight gain or loss following treatment

Required articles

- Infant weighing scale-infantometer or Electronic floor scale
- Towel or disposable lining
- Duster
- Paper and pencil for calculation

Procedure

In case of a child less than 2 years of age including Infant



Keep the weighing scale on hard and firm surface.

1. Clean the weighing scale with duster
2. Spread a towel or disposable lining on the scale
3. Balance the scale to read zero
4. Place the weighing scale close to the wall to prevent the child from falling
5. Instruct the mother to stand beside the scale
6. Undress the child before weighing leaving diaper alone
7. Place the infant on the scale
8. Place the left hand over the infant without touching
9. Note the weight
10. Lift the infant from the scale and help the mother to dress the infant
11. Check and compare previous weight
12. Difference of more than 100 gms, needs to be clarified by rechecking the infants weight immediately. If the difference is still the same, it should be informed to the doctor concerned.
13. If the weight is in pounds and it must be converted to kilograms using conversion table.
14. Document the weight. **1 Kg = 2.2 lbs**

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